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WEEKLY BULLETIN

25 December 2017



Battar, Nuwakot: a worker at 'Block Udhog' using a vibrator machine to produce hollow concrete blocks. This type of machine, can produce up to 250 blocks per day. Hollow concrete blocks have become an emerging trend in construction since the earthquake. HRRP are currently conducting a second round of research into hollow concrete block production across earthquake affected districts. This will build on [research conducted in December 2016](#).

Highlights

- HRRP District Orientations on the Repair & Retrofitting and Hybrid Structure Manuals will be starting from 27 December. For details on orientations in specific districts please contact the HRRP District Management Team, dmt@hrrpnepal.org, or the relevant [District Technical Coordinator](#).
- [Nepal Multidimensional Poverty Index 2018](#) published by the National Planning Commission
- [Launch of the Nepal Flood Resilience Portal](#)
- DFID Springboard Retrofitting Project Update: 36 retrofitted houses, in 17 locations, across 9 districts
- Merry Christmas to all HRRP Partners!

UPDATES & REQUESTS

National

NRA 5W Reporting: to date 150 out of 154 (97%) POs have reported to the NRA 5W. We understand that many POs who have already reported are having issues with logging in to, and using the reporting system. HRRP is working with NRA to address these issues. If your organisation is facing any issues reporting to the 5W, please contact Keshab Shrestha (im.national@hrrpnepal.org). Once the NRA 5W is fully up and running the HRRP 4W will be phased out.

Launch of the Nepal Flood Resilience Portal: the portal was launched on 21 December and is intended to provide easy access to the most locally-relevant flood risk reduction resources and inform resilience-building activities.

WASH Cluster Meeting, 19 December: the meeting included three major sessions; 1. Review of flood response, 2. Presentation of [DRM Guideline](#), and 3. Presentation of [International Conference on "Water, Environment and Climate Change: Knowledge Sharing and Partnership"](#). The session on the flood response included a report on the recent joint monitoring visit conducted by WASH cluster partners. The visit provided an opportunity to analyse the quality of the response, and to document challenges and strengths to contribute to improvements for future responses.

Saudi Arabia to Contribute USD 30 million to Support Reconstruction: the Saudi Arabian Government has shown interest to provide USD 30 million (approximately 3 billion NPRs) as a loan to the GoN to support post-earthquake reconstruction.

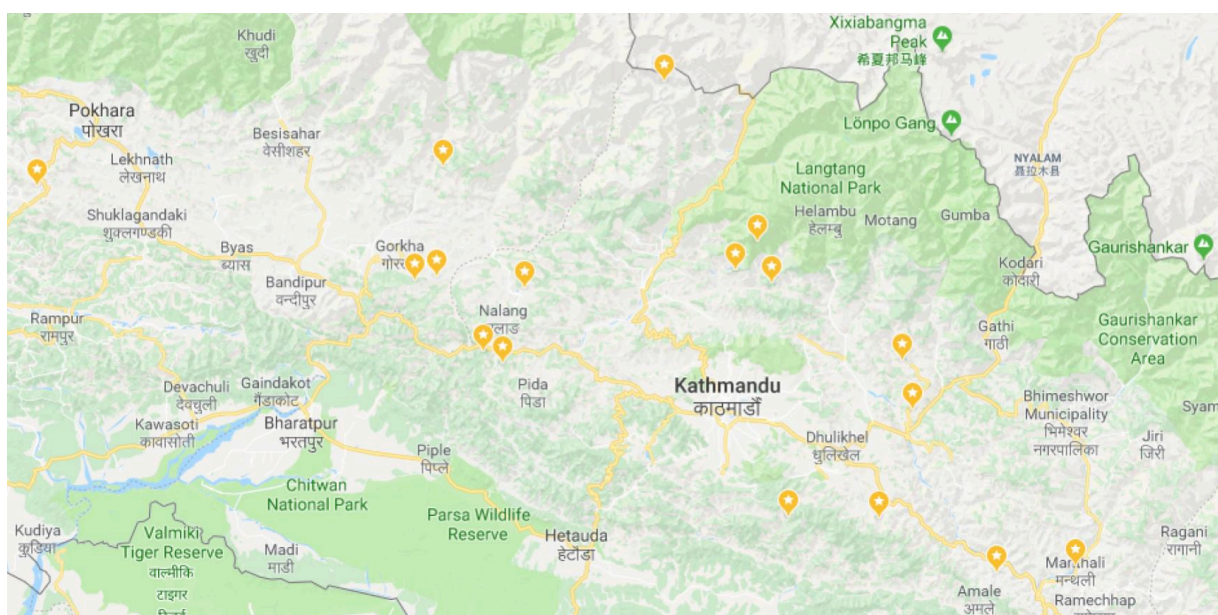
Districts

HRRP District Orientations on the Repair & Retrofitting and Hybrid Structure Manuals: the dates of the orientations in each of the 14 districts are provided below. For details on orientations in specific districts please contact the HRRP District Management Team, dmt@hrrpnepal.org, or the relevant district contact.

District	Date	Contact Person
Nuwakot	26 December	Badri Pyakurel, dc.nuwakot@hrrpnepal.org
Gorkha	27 December	Atit Shrestha, techcord.gorkha@hrrpnepal.org
Kathmandu Valley	27 December	Sweata Sijapati, techcord.ktm@hrrpnepal.org
Dolakha	27 December	Binod Kumar Kalaune, techcord.dolakha@hrrpnepal.org
Okhaldhunga	27 December	Prakash Basnet, prakash@hrrpnepal.org
Ramechhap	28 December	Tulsi Ram Lamichhane, techcord.okhaldhunga@hrrpnepal.org
Dhading	28 December	Sachin Sapkota, techcord.dhading@hrrpnepal.org
Rasuwa	28 December	Rijan Gajurel, im.rasuwa@hrrpnepal.org
Makwanpur	28 December	Kausal Bahadur Bist, techcord.makwanpur@hrrpnepal.org
Sindhupalchowk	29 December	Aarju Basnet, techcord.sindhupalchok@hrrpnepal.org
Kavre	29 December	Reshma Shrestha, reshma@hrrpnepal.org
Sindhuli	2 January 2018	Kuber Bogati, techofficer1.national@hrrpnepal.org

DFID Springboard Retrofitting Project Update: 36 retrofitted houses, in 17 locations across 9 districts were successfully managed through the Springboard project which has recently closed. Various take-up models were tested including home owner driven, entrepreneur and private sector driven, partner organization driven, type design development and training development models. Retrofits were implemented in the mid-hills and northern areas of the 14 most earthquake districts and in the additional 17 districts.

The base type design for stone with mud mortar (SMM) #1 was successfully approved by NRA Technical Committee and MoUD CLPIU in the summer. Further customisation options for SMM, as well as a heavyweight design for dry stone have been developed, piloted, and submitted to CLPIU for approval. Almost 100 engineers participated in the 7-day engineering on the SMM type design or received on site coaching. Almost 2,000 NRA/DUDBC field inspectors have received orientation training on the initial type design and related tools (go/no-go assessment and tranche release inspection checklist etc.) through this project. An additional 1,000 NRA/DUDBC field inspectors also received the orientation training through adjacent funding. Almost 200 local builders participated in on-the-job training to deliver the 36 retrofits. Finalisation of mason training curricula is currently ongoing together with Helvetas Employment Fund. For more information on retrofitting please contact Sandeep Man Shakya, Project Manager, Build Change sandeep@buildchange.org.



Map of 17 Springboard retrofit locations.



A trainee builder practicing shoring as a part of OJT in Chyamurunbesi, Kavre. Delivered in partnership with Helvetas Employment Fund and private sector service provider NETSA.



Builder Trainer from Build Change delivering retrofitting on-site coaching to a trainee builder in Sangachok, Sindhupalchok with partner organisation WVIN.



Example CLPIU orientation session in Dhulikhel, Kavre, led by Lead Structural Engineer Liva Shrestha



Retrofitted house at Shaurpani, Gorkha in partnership with Oxfam and local partners.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Kavre, Weekly District Report, 15 - 21 Dec 2017](#)



Bethanchok Rural Municipality (formerly Chyamrangbesi-5), Kavre: the house has been constructed using stone and mud mortar masonry and RCC bands and the home owner has received the second tranche. Photo Credit: Helvetas.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Ramechhap, Weekly District Report, 15 - 21 Dec 2017](#)



Kathajor (Manthali-3), Ramechhap: the house has been constructed using stone and mud mortar masonry with RCC bands and has an attic with light gable walls. The home owner has received the second tranche. Technical assistance was provided by SDC-SW Nepal during the construction. Photo Credit: Mr. Jeevesh Karna, District Housing Coordinator, Homeowner Support Project, SDC-SW Nepal.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Nuwakot, Weekly District Report, 15 – 21 Dec 2017](#)



Belkotgadhi-5, Nuwakot: the home owner has started building his 2 room house. He has received the first tranche and will apply for the second tranche soon. He stated that the cost of the building is expected to increase since he had to transport construction materials from Dharke, Dhading. He estimates that he will construct the house for within 4 lakhs and he is working on a rotation basis with other masons.

Requests for Partner Support

Winterisation Needs: partners are requested to share information on households winterisation needs using this template. The objective is to identify earthquake affected households, particularly those still living in temporary shelter, who require additional support to manage winter impacts on their living conditions. The data will also help to determine the type of support required. Completed templates should be submitted to the HRRP District Management Team, dmt@hrrpnepal.org.

Female Masons Questionnaire: HRRP would greatly appreciate it if partners could support with conducting semi-structured interviews, using this [questionnaire](#), across earthquake affected districts to try to better understand the engagement of women in masons training, and how they can engage in masonry work post-training. Completed questionnaires should be shared with the HRRP Recovery Advisor, siobhan@hrrpnepal.org. The compiled information will be used to identify steps that can be taken to strengthen women's engagement in masonry work and in the overall recovery.

DOCUMENTS & PRODUCTS

Government of Nepal

[MoUD DLPIU Engineer Job Description \(Nepali and Unofficial English Translation\)](#), [Sub-Engineer Job Description \(Nepali and Unofficial English Translation\)](#), and [Assistant Sub-Engineer Job Description \(Nepali and Unofficial English Translation\)](#).

Nepal Multidimensional Poverty Index 2018: published by the National Planning Commission and the Oxford Poverty and Human Development Initiative (OPHDI) the study found that "28.6% of Nepal's population is multidimensionally poor" and that "the indicators that contribute most to multidimensional poverty in Nepal are undernutrition and households that lack any member who has completed five years of schooling".

Multi-sector Nutrition Plan for Accelerating the Reduction of Maternal and Child Under-nutrition in Nepal (MNSP II): the Government of Nepal launched the plan, which covers 2018-2022, targeting women, children, and adolescent girls in the country last week. The MSNP II was endorsed and approved by the cabinet of the National Planning Commission, with the support of the European Union and UNICEF.

HRRP

HRRP General Meeting & District Exhibition, 13 December: the HRRP presentation from the meeting is available [here](#) and a live recording of the event can be accessed [here](#). The district exhibition materials are also available:

[Dhading](#)
[Dolakha](#)
[Gorkha](#)
[Kathmandu Valley](#)
[Kavrepalanchok](#)
[Makwanpur](#)
[Nuwakot](#)
[Okhaldhunga](#)
[Ramechhap](#)
[Rasuwa](#)
[Sindhuli](#)
[Sindhupalchok](#)

Municipal Level Maps: as presented during the general meeting, the HRRP team are working on transitioning data collection and visualisation to municipal level. The following maps are now available at municipal level:

[Administrative map of 31 EQ affected districts](#)
[Coverage of 7 Technical Assistance Activities \(as of 25 Nov 2017\)](#)
[Areas with No Technical Assistance with Damage Overlay \(as of 25 Nov 2017\)](#)
[Door to Door Technical Assistance \(as of 25 Nov 2017\)](#)
[Demonstration Construction House \(as of 25 Nov 2017\)](#)
[Helpdesks/ Technical Resources Center \(as of 25 Nov 2017\)](#)
[Community & Household Orientation - Technical Assistance \(as of 25 Nov 2017\)](#)
[Vocational Training Coverage \(as of 25 Nov 2017\)](#)
[Short Training Coverage \(as of 25 Nov 2017\)](#)

Partners

[Women, Gender, and Work, Volume 2, International Labour Organisation \(ILO\)](#): this document builds on [volume 1](#), published in 2001, and aims to provide practical and up to date strategies to address social choices and inequalities impacting on women, and men, in the work place.

[‘The gender gap in employment: What's holding women back?’, Infostory, ILO](#)

[IRC WASH Talk Podcast, Episode 8, Delivering Gender Positive WASH in the SDG Era](#): in this episode, the host talks with Gabrielle Halcrow of SNV Australia about the importance of including women and girls in WASH. Not just as participants but also as decision makers at district and national level. Practical steps are discussed to get relevant inclusion using data, which can be used to influence decision makers on why it is important to involve women. This is a first step in getting monitoring systems built in, budgeted and actually implemented by governments.

[‘Women migrant workers still working under unclear, unfair contracts, study finds, despite availability of best-practice templates’, UN Women and IOM](#): hundreds of thousands of women migrant workers are labouring under contracts they don't understand, in languages they cannot read, or that provide inadequate protection of their rights, a study has found. This problem persists despite the available of templates such as the [Standards Terms of Employment \(STOE\)](#). The findings were discussed at a stakeholder consultation in Kathmandu, Nepal, on 20 and 21 December. Please contact Sumiran Shrestha, Sumiran.shrestha@unwomen.org, for further information.

[Milijuli Nepali, Episode 822](#): this episode focuses on the details to be considered while building the walls of a concrete house. To record this episode, NRA engineer Kusum Dev who is mobilised to oversee the construction work in Gokarneshwor, Kathmandu, and Sarada Danuwar, a mason from Panchkhal, Kavre, were present in the studio. Kusum Dev explains details for the measurement of walls for building a single-storey and multi-storey house. Sarada Danuwar talks about the correct placement of windows. She said that the windows should be placed at 2 feet from the corners of the room. They also explained the importance of lintels to make the structure of the house robust. The episode also incorporates stories from Dolakha about people's concern related to the placement of windows and the use of partition walls for large rooms.

[Mapping the Vulnerability of Mountain Peoples to Food Insecurity, Food and Agriculture Organisation of the United Nations \(FAO\)](#): this study, conducted by FAO and the Mountain Partnership Secretariat, draws attention to an alarming fact: in 2012, 39% of the mountain population in developing countries, including Nepal, was considered vulnerable to food insecurity, which is an increase of 30% compared to the conditions of mountain peoples in the year 2000.

Baliyo Ghar TV Programme, Episode 83: this week's episode focuses on how the reconstruction is progressing in Sindhupalchowk, providing updates on reconstruction data from the district as well as looking at best practices being implemented there. The programme airs on Kantipur TV today at 7:30 PM, News24 TV on Wed @8:00AM, and Avenues TV on Sat @8:30AM. The programme will be repeated twice on each channel.



The poster for 'Baliyo Ghar' TV Programme, Episode 83, features a pink and orange background. At the top left is the 'बालियो घर' (Baliyo Ghar) logo. The main title in Nepali is 'सिन्धुपाल्चोक पुनर्निर्माणको पछिल्लो अपडेट' (Latest update on reconstruction in Sindhupalchowk), with 'भाग - ८३' (Part - 83) on the right. Below the title are three portrait photos of men. Under each photo is a logo and broadcast schedule: Kantipur TV (Sunday 7:00 PM & Monday 01:30 PM), News24 (Wednesday 8:00 AM, 2:00 PM & Thursday 04:30 AM), and Avenues TV (Saturday 8:30 AM, Sunday 04:30 AM & 03:00 PM). At the bottom, it lists 'Supported By: USAID', 'Presented By: NSET', and 'Media Partner: Avenues TV'.

'Prepare Pokhara', Secondary Cities Initiative and Kathmandu Living Labs: a new mobile application which brings robust geospatial data for Pokhara into an accessible space online. It is hoped that the critical infrastructure information made available through the app will play a part in communities' preparedness for, and response to disasters.

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